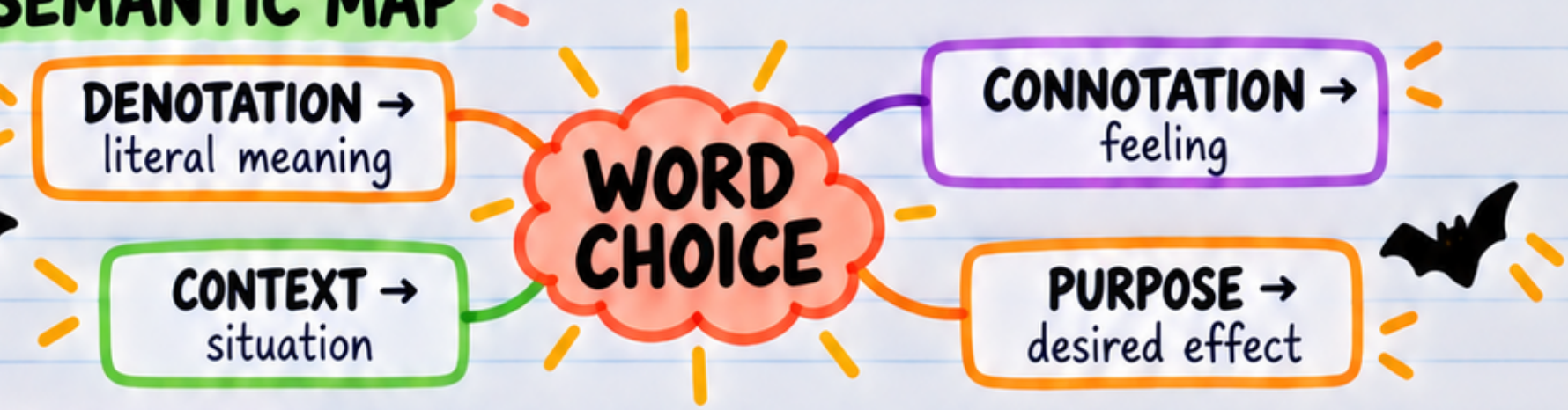
DENOTATION & CONNOTATION

SUMMARY

Denotation is the literal dictionary meaning.
Connotation is the feeling or association a word suggests.
Context and purpose guide word choice.

SEMANTIC MAP



EXAMPLES

- youthful / young / immature (positive / neutral / negative)
- fragrant / smelly (pleasant / unpleasant)

EXERCISES

1. A coach praises a supportive teammate:
loyal or clingy? Explain.

2. A reviewer criticizes a room full of unwanted objects:
cluttered or decorated? Explain.

3. A factual age description:
72 years old or ancient? Explain.

CHALLENGE

Describe the same place twice: once welcoming and once critical. Underline words that change the feeling.